IaC Confluent Cloud AWS Egress Private Linking, Infrastructure and Networking Example

This Terraform workspace provisions **Confluent Cloud Egress PrivateLink** infrastructure that enables Enterprise Kafka cluster connectors to reach external AWS services over private networking — without traversing the public internet.

It provisions two egress patterns side by side, sharing a single egress gateway:

- **S3 Sink Connector** — native AWS PrivateLink service, fully automated
- **JDBC Source/Sink Connector** — self-managed database behind a Network Load Balancer, requires one manual AWS acceptance step

It is a downstream workspace that depends on the environment ID output from the ingress PrivateLink workspace.

> **Terraform Cloud Workspace:** `iac-cc-aws-egress-privatelink-infrastructure-networking-example` **Organization:** `signalroom`

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1.0 Overview

AWS PrivateLink supports two directions of connectivity in Confluent Cloud:

Direction	Gateway Type	Purpose
Ingress	`aws_ingress_private_link_gateway`	Your VPC → Confluent Cloud Kafka clusters
Egress	`aws_egress_private_link_gateway`	Confluent Cloud connectors → Your AWS services

This workspace manages the **egress** direction. One egress gateway is allowed per AWS region per Confluent Cloud environment, and it is shared across all Enterprise clusters in that environment, and across both the S3 and JDBC access points provisioned here.

2.0 Why JDBC Egress Is Structurally Different from S3

This is the central architectural distinction in this workspace and the reason the JDBC pattern requires significantly more AWS infrastructure.

2.1 S3: Native AWS PrivateLink Service

S3 is a first-party AWS service with a pre-existing, AWS-managed PrivateLink endpoint service in every region (`com.amazonaws.<region>.s3`). Because AWS already owns and operates that endpoint service, Confluent can connect to it directly, there is no Network Load Balancer (NLB) to create, no endpoint service to configure, and no access acceptance step. AWS manages the allowlist implicitly.

Confluent resolves the standard S3 hostname (`s3.<region>.amazonaws.com`) to the VPC endpoint transparently via the `confluent_dns_record`. The S3 connector does not need to know it is communicating over PrivateLink.

The entire S3 egress path is **fully automated by Terraform** and transitions to `Ready` without any manual steps.

2.2 JDBC: Self-Managed Service Behind a Network Load Balancer

A database, whether RDS, EC2-hosted, or on-premises, is not a native AWS PrivateLink service. AWS PrivateLink can only front services that are exposed through a **Network Load Balancer**. This means before Confluent can create a VPC endpoint to your database, you must first build the AWS-side PrivateLink infrastructure yourself:

Layer	Resource	Why it's needed
Target registration	`aws_lb_target_group` + `aws_lb_target_group_attachment`	Registers the database's private IP with a specific port
Traffic control	`aws_security_group` + rules	Restricts NLB access to the database port and VPC CIDR
Load balancer	`aws_lb` (internal, Network)	AWS PrivateLink requires an internal NLB as the backing service
PrivateLink exposure	`aws_vpc_endpoint_service`	Wraps the NLB as a PrivateLink-addressable endpoint service

Only after this AWS infrastructure exists can Confluent create a VPC endpoint against it via `confluent_access_point`.

There is also a **step that Terraform cannot automate**: even though this workspace pre-authorizes Confluent's IAM principal in `aws_vpc_endpoint_service.allowed_principals`, AWS still requires explicit operator acceptance of each new endpoint connection request. This is an AWS-enforced safety gate (`acceptance_required = true`) that exists regardless of the allowlist — it prevents accidental or unauthorized endpoint connections. The `confluent_access_point` will remain in `Pending accept` until an operator accepts it in the AWS console.

Side-by-Side Comparison

Dimension	S3 Egress	JDBC Egress
Endpoint service owner	AWS	You
AWS resources required	None	Target group, NLB, security group, endpoint service
Service name source	Interpolated: `com.amazonaws.${region}.s3`	Dynamic: `aws_vpc_endpoint_service.jdbc.service_name`
IAM principal allowlist	Not applicable — AWS manages	Automated via `allowed_principals` in Terraform
Manual acceptance step	None — transitions directly to `Ready`	Required — operator must accept in AWS console
HA recommended	No — S3 is regionally redundant	Yes — `enable_high_availability = true` to deploy NICs across AZs
DNS domain	AWS standard: `s3.<region>.amazonaws.com`	Your database FQDN: must exactly match connector `connection.url`
NLB cross-zone required	No	Yes — prevents AZ-mismatch failures between Confluent's endpoint NICs and NLB subnets
Connector config impact	Transparent — connector uses standard S3 endpoint	Explicit — connector `connection.url` hostname must match `database_domain`

Architecture

```
flowchart TB

    subgraph TFC["Terraform Cloud — signalroom"]
        direction TB
        WS1["Workspace: iac-cc-aws-privatelink-infrastructure-networking-
example\n(Ingress — upstream)"]
        WS2["Workspace: iac-cc-aws-egress-privatelink-infrastructure-
networking-example\n(Egress — this workspace)"]
        WS1 -- "output: non_prod_environment_id\n→ var:
confluent_environment_id" --> WS2
    end

    subgraph CCLOUD["Confluent Cloud — non-prod Environment"]
        direction TB

        subgraph SHARED["Shared Gateway"]

EGW["confluent_gateway.non_prod_egress\naws_egress_private_link_gateway\n———————
————————————\nExposes: principal_arn\n(IAM role Confluent uses\nto create VPC
endpoints)"]
            SLEEP["time_sleep\n2 min provisioning wait"]
```

```
            EGW --> SLEEP
        end

        subgraph S3PATH["S3 Egress Path — Fully Automated"]
            S3AP["confluent_access_point.egress_s3\nService:
com.amazonaws.REGION.s3\nHA: false"]
            S3DNS["confluent_dns_record.egress_s3\nDomain:
s3.REGION.amazonaws.com"]
            S3AP --> S3DNS
        end

        subgraph JDBCPATH["JDBC Egress Path — Requires Manual Acceptance"]
            JDBCAP["confluent_access_point.egress_jdbc\nService:
aws_vpc_endpoint_service.jdbc\nHA: true  ← multi-AZ NICs"]
            JDBCDNS["confluent_dns_record.egress_jdbc\nDomain:
var.database_domain\n(must match connector connection.url)"]
            JDBCAP --> JDBCDNS
        end

        SLEEP --> S3AP
        SLEEP --> JDBCAP
    end

    subgraph AWS["AWS — Database VPC"]
        direction TB

        subgraph JDBC_INFRA["JDBC AWS Infrastructure (owned by you)"]
            direction TB
            TG["aws_lb_target_group.jdbc\nProtocol: TCP\nTarget type: ip\nPort:
database_port"]
            TGA["aws_lb_target_group_attachment.jdbc\nTarget:
database_private_ip"]
            SG["aws_security_group.nlb_jdbc\nIngress: database_port from VPC
CIDR\nEgress: all"]
            NLB["aws_lb.jdbc\nInternal Network Load Balancer\ncross_zone:
enabled\nPrivateLink inbound rule enforcement: off"]
            LIS["aws_lb_listener.jdbc\nTCP:database_port → target group"]
            EPCSVC["aws_vpc_endpoint_service.jdbc\nacceptance_required:
true\nallowed_principals:
egress_gateway_iam_principal\n──────────────────────────────\n⚠ Manual step
required:\nAWS Console → Endpoint connections\n→ Accept pending connection"]

            TG --> TGA
            SG --> NLB
            TG --> NLB
            NLB --> LIS
            LIS --> EPCSVC
        end

        subgraph DB["Database"]
            DATABASE["RDS / EC2 / On-
premises\ndatabase_private_ip:database_port"]
        end

        TGA --> DATABASE
    end
```

```
    subgraph S3SVC["AWS — S3 (AWS-managed PrivateLink service)"]
        S3EP["com.amazonaws.REGION.s3\nAWS-owned endpoint service\n(no NLB, no
acceptance step)"]
        S3BUCKET["Amazon S3 Bucket\n──────────────────\nBucket Policy:\n•
Principal: egress_gateway_iam_principal\n• Condition: aws:sourceVpce:
egress_s3_vpc_endpoint_id"]
        S3EP --> S3BUCKET
    end

    subgraph OUTPUTS["Terraform Outputs"]
        OG1["egress_gateway_id"]
        OG2["egress_gateway_iam_principal\n→ S3 bucket policy Principal\n→ JDBC
allowed_principals (automated)"]
        OS1["egress_s3_access_point_id"]
        OS2["egress_s3_vpc_endpoint_id\n→ S3 bucket policy aws:sourceVpce"]
        OJ1["egress_jdbc_access_point_id"]
        OJ2["egress_jdbc_vpc_endpoint_id"]
        OJ3["nlb_arn / nlb_dns_name"]
        OJ4["jdbc_connector_connection_url_hint\n→ connector connection.url"]
    end

    %% Confluent creates VPC endpoints via its IAM principal
    S3AP -- "Confluent creates Interface\nVPC Endpoint (automated)" --> S3EP
    JDBCAP -- "Confluent creates Interface\nVPC Endpoint (pending accept)" -->
EPCSVC

    %% Output wiring
    EGW --> OG1
    EGW --> OG2
    S3AP --> OS1
    S3AP --> OS2
    JDBCAP --> OJ1
    JDBCAP --> OJ2
    NLB --> OJ3
    JDBCDNS --> OJ4

    style TFC fill:#f5f0ff,stroke:#7c3aed,color:#1a1a1a
    style CCLOUD fill:#e8f4fd,stroke:#0066cc,color:#1a1a1a
    style AWS fill:#fff3e0,stroke:#e65100,color:#1a1a1a
    style S3SVC fill:#fef9e7,stroke:#b7950b,color:#1a1a1a
    style OUTPUTS fill:#e8f5e9,stroke:#2e7d32,color:#1a1a1a
    style SHARED fill:#dbeafe,stroke:#1d4ed8,color:#1a1a1a
    style S3PATH fill:#dcfce7,stroke:#15803d,color:#1a1a1a
    style JDBCPATH fill:#fce7f3,stroke:#9d174d,color:#1a1a1a
    style JDBC_INFRA fill:#fff7ed,stroke:#c2410c,color:#1a1a1a
    style DB fill:#fef3c7,stroke:#b45309,color:#1a1a1a
```

S3 flow

```
Confluent Cloud (Enterprise Cluster)
  └── Egress Gateway
        └── Access Point → com.amazonaws.<region>.s3  (AWS-managed)
              └── confluent_dns_record: s3.<region>.amazonaws.com
```

```
                        └── Amazon S3 Bucket
                              └── Bucket Policy: restrict to
egress_s3_vpc_endpoint_id
```

JDBC flow

```
Confluent Cloud (Enterprise Cluster)
  └── Egress Gateway
        └── Access Point → aws_vpc_endpoint_service (you own this)
              └── confluent_dns_record: <database_domain>
                    └── NLB Listener (TCP:<database_port>)
                          └── Target Group → Database Private IP
                                └── Database (RDS / EC2 / on-premises)
```

Prerequisites

- An existing Confluent Cloud environment with at least one Enterprise Kafka cluster (provisioned by the ingress workspace)
- A database instance (RDS, EC2-hosted, or on-premises) with a known private IP and stable port
- The database VPC must have at least two private subnets spanning different AZs for NLB deployment
- AWS CLI with SSO configured (`aws2-wrap` required for `deploy.sh`)
- `graphviz` (`dot`) installed locally if you want the Terraform visualization generated by `deploy.sh`
- Terraform >= 1.5.0

Workspace Dependencies

This workspace consumes one output from the ingress workspace:

Output (ingress workspace)	Variable (this workspace)	Description
`non_prod_environment_id`	`confluent_environment_id`	Confluent Cloud environment ID

Set `confluent_environment_id` as a Terraform variable in TFC before the first apply.

Resources Provisioned

Shared

Resource	Type	Description
`confluent_gateway.non_prod_egress`	`confluent_gateway`	Egress PrivateLink gateway — shared by S3 and JDBC access points
`time_sleep.wait_for_egress_gateway`	`time_sleep`	2-minute delay for Confluent control plane to fully provision the gateway

S3 Egress

Resource	Type	Description
`confluent_access_point.egress_s3`	`confluent_access_point`	Interface VPC Endpoint targeting `com.amazonaws.<region>.s3`
`confluent_dns_record.egress_s3`	`confluent_dns_record`	Maps `s3.<region>.amazonaws.com` to the S3 VPC endpoint

JDBC Egress

Resource	Type	Description
`aws_lb_target_group.jdbc`	`aws_lb_target_group`	IP-type target group for the database private IP and port
`aws_lb_target_group_attachment.jdbc`	`aws_lb_target_group_attachment`	Registers the database private IP in the target group
`aws_security_group.nlb_jdbc`	`aws_security_group`	Security group restricting NLB traffic to the database port and VPC CIDR
`aws_lb.jdbc`	`aws_lb`	Internal NLB fronting the database; cross-zone LB enabled, PrivateLink inbound rule enforcement disabled
`aws_lb_listener.jdbc`	`aws_lb_listener`	TCP listener on `database_port`, forwarding to the target group
`aws_vpc_endpoint_service.jdbc`	`aws_vpc_endpoint_service`	Exposes the NLB as a PrivateLink endpoint service; pre-authorizes Confluent's IAM principal

Resource	Type	Description
`confluent_access_point.egress_jdbc`	`confluent_access_point`	Interface VPC Endpoint targeting the JDBC endpoint service; HA enabled
`confluent_dns_record.egress_jdbc`	`confluent_dns_record`	Maps `database_domain` to the JDBC VPC endpoint

Input Variables

Confluent Cloud

Variable	Type	Sensitive	Description
`confluent_api_key`	`string`	No	Confluent Cloud API Key
`confluent_api_secret`	`string`	**Yes**	Confluent Cloud API Secret
`confluent_environment_id`	`string`	No	Confluent environment ID (from ingress workspace output `non_prod_environment_id`)

AWS Provider

Variable	Type	Sensitive	Description
`aws_region`	`string`	No	AWS region for all resources (e.g. `us-east-1`)
`aws_access_key_id`	`string`	No	AWS Access Key ID (populated by `deploy.sh` via SSO)
`aws_secret_access_key`	`string`	**Yes**	AWS Secret Access Key
`aws_session_token`	`string`	**Yes**	AWS Session Token

JDBC / Database

Variable	Type	Sensitive	Description
`database_vpc_id`	`string`	No	VPC ID where the database resides; NLB deploys here
`database_subnet_ids`	`string`	No	Comma-separated private subnet IDs for NLB deployment (span multiple AZs)
`database_private_ip`	`string`	No	Private IP of the database instance to register in the NLB target group
`database_port`	`number`	No	TCP port the database listens on (e.g. `5432`, `3306`, `1433`)

Variable	Type	Sensitive	Description
`database_domain`	`string`	No	FQDN used in the JDBC connector `connection.url`; must exactly match `confluent_dns_record` domain
`nlb_name`	`string`	No	Name for the NLB (default: `jdbc-egress-privatelink-nlb`)
`endpoint_service_name`	`string`	No	Friendly name for the VPC Endpoint Service (default: `jdbc-egress-privatelink-endpoint-service`)

Outputs

Gateway

Output	Description
`egress_gateway_id`	Confluent egress gateway ID — shared by S3 and JDBC
`egress_gateway_iam_principal`	IAM Principal ARN Confluent uses to create VPC endpoints; automatically set in `allowed_principals` for JDBC

S3

Output	Description	Used For
`egress_s3_access_point_id`	Confluent access point ID for S3	Reference in downstream configs
`egress_s3_vpc_endpoint_id`	AWS VPC endpoint ID for S3	**S3 bucket policy `aws:sourceVpce` condition**
`s3_connector_endpoint_hint`	Standard S3 endpoint hostname	Connector configuration reference

JDBC

Output	Description	Used For
`egress_jdbc_access_point_id`	Confluent access point ID for JDBC	Reference in downstream configs
`egress_jdbc_vpc_endpoint_id`	AWS VPC endpoint ID for JDBC	Database / NLB security group ingress rules
`nlb_arn`	NLB ARN	Troubleshooting, downstream reference
`nlb_dns_name`	NLB DNS name	Connectivity troubleshooting
`vpc_endpoint_service_name`	AWS PrivateLink service name	Visible in AWS console; reference only
`vpc_endpoint_service_id`	AWS Endpoint Service ID	Reference only

Output	Description	Used For
`jdbc_connector_connection_url_hint`	JDBC `connection.url` template	**Connector configuration**

Deployment

Using deploy.sh

`deploy.sh` handles AWS SSO authentication, exports all required `TF_VAR_*` environment variables, and runs `terraform init`, `plan`, and `apply` (or `destroy`) in sequence. It also generates a Terraform graph visualization at `docs/images/terraform-visualization.png` after each apply or destroy.

Create:

```
./deploy.sh create \
  --profile=<SSO_PROFILE_NAME> \
  --confluent-api-key=<CONFLUENT_API_KEY> \
  --confluent-api-secret=<CONFLUENT_API_SECRET> \
  --confluent-environment-id=<CONFLUENT_ENVIRONMENT_ID> \
  --database-vpc-id=<DATABASE_VPC_ID> \
  --database-subnet-ids=<SUBNET_ID_1,SUBNET_ID_2,SUBNET_ID_3> \
  --database-private-ip=<DATABASE_PRIVATE_IP> \
  --database-port=<DATABASE_PORT> \
  --database-domain=<DATABASE_FQDN>
```

Destroy:

```
./deploy.sh destroy \
  --profile=<SSO_PROFILE_NAME> \
  --confluent-api-key=<CONFLUENT_API_KEY> \
  --confluent-api-secret=<CONFLUENT_API_SECRET> \
  --confluent-environment-id=<CONFLUENT_ENVIRONMENT_ID> \
  --database-vpc-id=<DATABASE_VPC_ID> \
  --database-subnet-ids=<SUBNET_ID_1,SUBNET_ID_2,SUBNET_ID_3> \
  --database-private-ip=<DATABASE_PRIVATE_IP> \
  --database-port=<DATABASE_PORT> \
  --database-domain=<DATABASE_FQDN>
```

> **Note:** `database_subnet_ids` must be a comma-separated string with no spaces: `subnet-aaa,subnet-bbb,subnet-ccc`. The script passes this value unquoted so Terraform receives it correctly as a list.

Manual Terraform Steps

```
cd terraform

export TF_VAR_aws_region="us-east-1"
export TF_VAR_confluent_api_key="..."
```

```
export TF_VAR_confluent_api_secret="..."
export TF_VAR_confluent_environment_id="env-xxxxx"
export TF_VAR_database_vpc_id="vpc-xxxxx"
export TF_VAR_database_subnet_ids="subnet-aaa,subnet-bbb,subnet-ccc"
export TF_VAR_database_private_ip="10.0.1.55"
export TF_VAR_database_port=5432
export TF_VAR_database_domain="mydb.cluster-xxxx.us-east-1.rds.amazonaws.com"

terraform init
terraform plan -out=tfplan
terraform apply tfplan
```

The apply takes approximately **6–10 minutes** — 2 minutes for the gateway sleep, plus Confluent and AWS provisioning time for the NLB, endpoint service, and access points.

Post-Apply: Manual AWS Acceptance Step (JDBC only)

> **This step is required before the JDBC connector will work.** The S3 access point does not require this.

After `terraform apply` completes, the JDBC `confluent_access_point` will be in `Pending accept` state. AWS holds every new endpoint connection in this state as a safety gate, regardless of the `allowed_principals` pre-authorization.

1. In the **AWS Console**, navigate to **VPC → Endpoint services**
2. Select the endpoint service created by this workspace (tagged `jdbc-egress-privatelink-endpoint-service`)
3. Click the **Endpoint connections** tab
4. Select the pending connection and click **Actions → Accept endpoint connection**
5. Type `accept` to confirm

The `confluent_access_point` status will transition from `Pending accept` → `Ready`. The `confluent_dns_record` becomes active only after this transition.

Post-Apply: S3 Bucket Policy

After apply, update your S3 bucket policy to restrict access to Confluent's VPC endpoint. Using both the IAM principal and the VPC endpoint ID conditions prevents confused deputy attacks where another principal could attempt to route traffic through the same endpoint.

```
{
  "Version": "2012-10-17",
  "Statement": [
    {
      "Sid": "AllowConfluentEgressPrivateLink",
      "Effect": "Allow",
      "Principal": {
        "AWS": "<egress_gateway_iam_principal>"
      },
      "Action": [
        "s3:PutObject",
        "s3:GetObject",
```

```
          "s3:ListBucket",
          "s3:DeleteObject"
        ],
        "Resource": [
          "arn:aws:s3:::<your-bucket-name>",
          "arn:aws:s3:::<your-bucket-name>/*"
        ],
        "Condition": {
          "StringEquals": {
            "aws:sourceVpce": "<egress_s3_vpc_endpoint_id>"
          }
        }
      }
    ]
  }
```

Replace `<egress_gateway_iam_principal>` and `<egress_s3_vpc_endpoint_id>` with values from `terraform output`.

Connector Configuration

S3 Sink Connector

The S3 connector uses the standard AWS S3 endpoint. No special hostname configuration is needed — Confluent routes traffic over PrivateLink transparently via the DNS record.

```
{
  "connector.class": "S3_SINK",
  "s3.region": "<aws_region>",
  "s3.bucket.name": "<your-bucket-name>"
}
```

JDBC Source / Sink Connector

The `connection.url` hostname **must exactly match** the `database_domain` variable — this is what `confluent_dns_record` maps to the VPC endpoint. Any mismatch will result in a DNS resolution failure inside Confluent Cloud's network.

```
{
  "connector.class": "PostgresSource",
  "connection.url": "jdbc:postgresql://<database_domain>:
<database_port>/<database_name>",
  "connection.user": "...",
  "connection.password": "..."
}
```

The `jdbc_connector_connection_url_hint` output provides a pre-populated template with the correct hostname and port.

Adding More Egress Endpoints

The egress gateway is shared across all connectors in the `non-prod` environment. To add additional targets — another database, Snowflake, a custom internal service — add new `confluent_access_point` and `confluent_dns_record` resource blocks to `main.tf` referencing the same `confluent_gateway.non_prod_egress.id`.

For another self-managed service, follow the JDBC pattern: create a target group, NLB, and endpoint service first, then reference `aws_vpc_endpoint_service.<name>.service_name` in the access point.

For a third-party native PrivateLink service (Snowflake, MongoDB Atlas, etc.), follow the S3 pattern but substitute the provider-specific service name obtained from their documentation.

Troubleshooting

JDBC access point stuck in `Provisioning` or `Pending accept`

The endpoint connection request has not been accepted in the AWS console. See Post-Apply: Manual AWS Acceptance Step.

JDBC connector cannot reach the database even after access point is `Ready`

Check for an AZ mismatch: Confluent's endpoint NICs may land in an AZ where the NLB has no healthy targets. Cross-zone load balancing is enabled (`enable_cross_zone_load_balancing = true`) by default in this workspace. If it was disabled, re-enable it via **EC2 → Load Balancers → Actions → Edit load balancer attributes → Enable cross-zone balancing**.

RDS database IP changed after failover

RDS IPs can change after a failover or maintenance event. If the target group health check starts failing, update `database_private_ip` and re-apply. For production workloads, consider fronting RDS with RDS Proxy (stable DNS hostname) or PgBouncer on a fixed EC2 IP.

S3 connector access denied errors

Verify the S3 bucket policy includes `egress_s3_vpc_endpoint_id` in the `aws:sourceVpce` condition and that `egress_gateway_iam_principal` is listed as the Principal. Both must be present.

`deploy.sh` fails with `aws2-wrap: command not found`

Install `aws2-wrap`: `pip install aws2-wrap`. This is required for SSO credential export used by the script.